Passage One

Questions 46 to 50 are based on the following passage.

Technology is never a neutral tool for achieving human ends. Technological innovations reshape people as they use these innovations to control their environment. Artificial intelligence， for example， is altering humanity.

While the term AI conjures up anxieties about killer robots or catastrophic levels of unemployment， there are other， deeper implications. As AI increasingly shapes the human experience， how does this change what it means to be human? Central to the problem is a person's capacity to make choices， particularly judgments that have moral implications.

Aristotle argued that the capacity for making practical judgments depends on regularly making them—on habit and practice. We see the emergence of machines as substitute judges in a variety of everyday contexts as a potential threat to people learning how to effectively exercise judgment themselves.

In the workplace， managers routinely make decisions about who to hire or fire and which loan to approve， to name a few. These are areas where *algorithmic*（算法的）prescription is replacing human judgment， and so people who might have had the chance to develop practical judgment in these areas no longer will.

Recommendation engines， which are increasingly prevalent intermediaries in people's consumption of culture， may serve to constrain choice and minimize luck. By presenting consumers with algorithmically selected choices of what to watch， read， stream and visit next， companies are replacing human taste with machine taste. In one sense， this is helpful. After all， machines can survey a wider range of choices than any individual is likely to have the time or energy to do on their own.

At the same time， though， this selection is optimizing for what people are likely to prefer based on what they've preferred in the past. We think there is some risk that people's options will be constrained by their past they will ultimately make common experiences more efficient and pleasant.

Algorithms could soon—if they don't already—have a better idea about which show you'd like to watch next and which job candidate you should hire than you do. One day, humans may even find a way for machines to make these decisions without some of the biases that humans typically display.

But to the extent that unpredictability is part of how people understand themselves and part of what people like about themselves, humanity is in the process of losing something significant. As they become more and more predictable, the creatures inhabiting the increasingly AI-mediated world will become less and less like us.

46. What do we learn about the deeper implications of AI?
   A) It is causing catastrophic levels of unemployment.
   B) It is doing physical harm to human operators.
   C) It is altering moral judgments.
   D) It is reshaping humanity.

47. What is the consequence of algorithmic prescription replacing human judgment?
   A) People lose the chance to cultivate the ability to make practical judgments.
   B) People are prevented from participating in making major decisions in the workplace.
   C) Managers no longer have the chance to decide which loan to approve.
   D) Managers do not need to take the trouble to determine who to hire or fire.

48. What may result from increasing application of recommendation engines in our consumption of culture?
   A) Consumers will have much limited choice.
   B) Consumers will actually enjoy better luck.
   C) It will be easier to decide on what to enjoy.
   D) Humans will develop tastes similar to machines'.

49. What is likely to happen to larger parts of our daily life as machine learning algorithms improve?
   A) They will turn out to be more pleasant.
   B) They will repeat our past experience.
   C) They can be completely anticipated.
   D) They may become better and better.

50. Why does the author say the creatures living in the more and more AI-mediated world will become increasingly unlike us?
   A) They will have lost the most significant human element of being intelligent.
   B) They will no longer possess the human characteristic of being unpredictable.
   C) They will not be able to understand themselves as we can do today.
   D) They will be deprived of what their predecessors were proud of about themselves.

Passage Two

Questions 51 to 55 are based on the following passage.

Phonics, which involves sounding out words *syllable*（音节）by syllable, is the best way to teach children to read. But in many classrooms, this can be a dirty word. So much so that some teachers have had to sneak phonics teaching materials into the classroom. Most American children are taught to read in a way that study after study has found to be wrong.

The consequences of this are striking. Less than half of all American adults were proficient readers in 2017. American fourth graders rank 15th on the Progress in International Literacy Study, an international exam.

America is stuck in a debate about teaching children to read that has been going on for decades. Some advocate teaching symbol-sound relationships (the sound *k* can be spelled as c, k, ck, or ch), known as phonics. Others support an immersive approach (using pictures of a cat to learn the word *cat*), known as "whole language". Most teachers today, almost three out of four according to a survey by the EdWeek Research Centre in 2019, use a mix called "balanced literacy". This combination of methods is ineffective. "You can't sprinkle in a little phonics," says Tenette Smith, executive director of elementary education and reading at Mississippi's education department. "It has to be systematic and explicitly taught."

Mississippi, often behind in social policy, has set an example here. In a state once notorious for its low the first time since measurement began, Mississippi's pupils are now average readers, a remarkable achievement in such a poor state.

Mississippi's success is attributed to implementing reading methods supported by a body of research known as the science of reading. In 1997 Congress requested the National Institute of Child Health and Human Development and the Department of Education to convene a National Reading Panel to end the "reading wars" and synthesize the evidence. The panel found that phonics, along with explicit instruction in *phonemic*（音位的）awareness, fluency and comprehension, worked best.

Yet over two decades on, "balanced literacy" is still being taught in classrooms. But advances in statistics and brain imaging have disproved the whole-language method. To the teacher who is a proficient reader, literacy seems like a natural process that requires educated guessing, rather than the deliberate process emphasized by phonics. Teachers can imagine that they learned to read through *osmosis*（潜移默化）when they were children. Without proper training, they bring this to classrooms.

51. What do we learn about phonics in many American classrooms?

A) It is ill reputed.
C) It is arbitrarily excluded.
B) It is mostly misapplied.
D) It is misrepresented.

52. What has America been witnessing for decades?

A) An obsession with innovating teaching methodologies of reading.
B) An enduring debate over the approach to teaching children to read.
C) An increasing concern with many children's inadequacy in literacy.
D) An ever-forceful advocacy of a combined method for teaching reading.

53. Why does Tenette Smith think a combination of teaching methods is ineffective?

A) Elementary school children will be frustrated when taught with several methods combined.
B) Phonics has to be systematically applied and clearly taught to achieve the desired effect.
C) Sprinkling in a little phonics deters the progress of even adequately motivated children.
D) Balanced literacy fails to sustain children's interest in developing a good reading habit.

54. What does the author say Mississippi's success is attributed to?